SPLENDID MISS SAMANTHA
FROM *PUSHPA* TO *THE FAMILY MAN*, CARVING HER OWN NICHE

Q+A

SAMANTHA RUTH PRABHU
Actor

THE SENSE OF ARRIVAL

Samantha Ruth Prabhu's journey in the film industry has been about finding success by overcoming fear



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Q. How did you know about your illness?
I was part of the hustle culture. For 14 years, I had one blockbuster after another, but I always had this feeling that I wasn't good enough. The greatest thing I've learned from battling the autoimmune condition myositis for almost two years is that rest is not taking your foot off the gas, it's putting fuel in the tank.

Q. So, you didn't get to enjoy all your successes?
I wish I could say yes, but I didn't. I never owned my victories. The feeling of having arrived is subjective for different people. For some, it's their successes. But, for me, the feeling of arriving is to arrive to a place where I have finally given myself the permission to be my authentic self–all of the imperfections, all of the flaws, all of the hardships.

Q. Were you worried about being stereotyped when doing the item number 'Oo Antava'?
The decision to do it came from a place of needing to explore a new facet of being an actor... The first shot I was shaking from fear because sexy is not my thing. I've always made sure that I put myself in the most uncomfortable circumstances... kind of slaying these demons I have.

Q. You learned a lot of action for your next project, *Citadel*.
It was actually the hardest role of my life simply because I had to do it when I was really weak. For me, the show is already a success because I shot for it under the most gruelling circumstances. I didn't think that I could do it, but now I can say I'm very proud of myself.